

Overview of Wish I'd Listened Then

Wish I'd Listened Then is a six-part narrative poem excerpted from my book, *My Life: Between Time & Eternity*. Told from the perspective of a man who is left behind after the Rapture, the poem traces his journey from complacency and unbelief to conviction and faith in the midst of the Tribulation.

The story begins in the ordinary rhythms of everyday life. Without warning, those familiar surroundings are shattered by the disappearance of his family and countless others. Only afterward does he begin to understand the warnings he once dismissed and the significance of the gospel he had previously rejected.

Jesus warned of the coming Tribulation:

“For then there will be great tribulation, such as has not been since the beginning of the world until this time, no, nor ever shall be.” — Matthew 24:21

From the peaceful simplicity of *Ordinary Days* to the shock of *The Harpazo (Rapture)*, the awakening of *The Reckoning*, and the trials of *The Tribulation*, the poem follows one man's spiritual awakening as the world around him descends into unprecedented turmoil. In *The Refining Fire* and *Martyred Victory*, the story moves beyond fear and suffering toward perseverance, faith, and ultimate victory in Christ.

At its heart, *Wish I'd Listened Then* is both a warning and an invitation. It is a poetic reflection on the terrible consequences of rejecting Christ and the cost of discovering the truth too late. Yet even within its darkness, the poem points toward hope: faith in Christ is worth whatever it costs, and death is not the end for those who belong to Him.

The message is simple and urgent:

It is never too early to come to Christ—but there will come a day when it is too late.

Maranatha.

Wish I'd Listened Then

I. Ordinary Days

Sitting on the front porch rocking in my chair,
Trying to doze off without a care,
Just like any other day to compare,
Kids making a racket on the stairs.

The neighbors are barbecuing with their usual flair,
A red kite is soaring high in the air,

My wife walks by fidgeting with her hair,
Says, "A great day to go to the fair!"

II. The Harpazo (Rapture)

Then came a sudden, shocking, shattering affair.
I found myself alone, playing solitaire,
Caught completely off guard, unaware,
I thought, "Good heavens! Why am I so scared?"

There was no warning till the trumpet blared,
The earth didn't move or declare,
But many vehicles needed repair,
And now, I'm in agonizing despair.

My family has vanished into thin air,
Faint echoes of laughter—a whispered prayer,
Their garments scattered everywhere,
A weight no heart should have to bear.

III. The Reckoning

They tried hard to make me aware,
Warning me all the time to beware,
But all I would do is glare,
Or poke fun at them with a dare.

And all those crazy folks that went to church on the Square,
Turned out they had a hold of the glory and are heirs.
All I can do is sit in this chair,
Reflecting on my terrible error.

Of late, I have sought out the *Covenant Pair*,
Often bowing my head in fervent prayer,
Fighting back those anguishing tears,
Wishing I had partaken in the shares.

IV. The Tribulation

Waiting on the brand,
Crying every day for this land,
Knowing I have to take a stand,
There is a line drawn in the sand.
Though Homeland Defense may demand,
I cannot go against God's command,
Nothing can thwart His divine plan,

Which was destined before time began.

These days, there is very little sleeping,
But a lot of nighttime pleading,
My heart is broken and bleeding,
The truth is unveiled in scripture reading.

“They’re coming soon,” says the tip,
Because we won’t take the chip,
They want to change our zip,
Move us to camps down the strip.

Some have already been whipped,
Others were beaten and stripped,
I have got to get a grip,
And be ready to take this trip.

The whole world reels in turmoil,
The soaring price of oil,
Crazy diseases and freshwater spoils,
As the heat of the sun cooks and boils.

There has been upheaval in the heavens,
The earth wobbles under the weight of a series of sevens,
These times and seasons are a leaven of terror,
And a blood-red moon becomes the color bearer.

The restless roaring of the ocean waves,
A multitude of people became de facto slaves,
Billions have already gone to their graves,
But the media raves about the future he will save.

Saying, “Our global leader is brilliant and astute,
He has all the answers and powers to boot,”
The problem is, I know the truth,
No way I dare to taste the fruit.

V. The Refining Fire

They’ve seized me now; there’s no escape,
Under the Antichrist’s cruel mandate,
Beatings and threats are a daily fare,
Yet hope ascends beyond despair.

It looks like the end of the line,
The trucks are starting to align,

Wish I'd listened back then to the signs,
And I wouldn't be here being attacked and maligned.

Hanging on like a naked stem in a strong wind,
If only, I had confessed that I'd sinned,
A hard-headed man left behind,
Tragically choosing to remain blind.

I've got to keep my nose to the grind,
And fight to steady both heart and mind,
The final epic battle now nears for all mankind;
And so, we know the whole world will be refined.

VI. Martyred Victory

The trucks move briskly down the road,
Troubled faces weighed with heavy load,
Approaching our final stop, we slow,
Concerned reflection ponders what we owe.

As destiny drives onward, we tread slowly ahead,
Ever mindful of where we are being led,
Each heartbeat echoes what Christ has said,
Faith will overcome the lingering dread.

Only now do I fully comprehend,
As I leave this world to meet my Friend;
The heavens open, split, and bend,
We meet our Savior—the Beginning and the End.